

SENDKIT DOCS

Bounce types and validation

Not all bounces mean the same thing, and validation is already doing more work than most people realize.

Hard bounces vs soft bounces

Hard bounce

The address doesn't exist, the domain is wrong, or the mailbox has been permanently shut down. These addresses will never deliver and should come out of your list.

Soft bounce

Temporary: a full inbox, a server briefly down, or a provider throttling delivery. A soft bounce today doesn't mean the address is bad, it can deliver fine on a later attempt.

When deciding whether to revalidate a list, hard bounces are the number to watch. A rising hard bounce rate means the list itself has gone stale or was never properly verified. A soft bounce spike is more often a temporary delivery hiccup.

Validation that's already built in

- **Included, not extra.** Email validation runs for free as part of your SendKit plan. You don't need a separate tool just to check whether addresses are real before you send to them.
- **Works alongside external validators too.** If you already use a tool like BounceBan, there's no conflict running it alongside SendKit's built-in validation. Many senders layer both, one catching what the other might miss, rather than picking just one.
- **Scales with your list.** Your validation allowance isn't a flat number, it scales with your active lead count, so a bigger list isn't left under-validated relative to a smaller one.

A SMALL DROP ON IMPORT IS NORMAL

When you import a new list, don't be surprised if the lead count that lands is a few percent lower, typically around 5%, than what you uploaded. That gap is SendKit deduplicating against leads you already have, not data loss. It's expected behavior, not something to troubleshoot.

Why this works on SendKit

Because validation is included and scales with your list automatically, you're not stuck choosing between paying for a separate tool and sending to an unverified list.

Validate your current list

Run your active list through SendKit's built-in validation before your next send, then compare the hard bounce count against your last campaign.

[Validate my list](#)